



Gizmo Giftology

What do geeks really want their friends / relatives / significant others to buy them this Diwali?

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It's that time of the year when you raid your distant relative's houses (even if you haven't seen them in the past year), gorge on sweets, fancy up your crib, add to the noise pollution and generally having a blast. Above all else, what us geeks look forward to the most in Diwali is receiving those awesome gifts. Well, maybe giving gifts too, but let's be honest, who doesn't like getting them freebies, right? Well, this got us thinking. What gifts do geeks really want? We decided to go through the crowdsourcing model and ask our readers what they wanted through Facebook, the Digit forum and our newsletters.

Within a week, we had a ton of responses. Readers from all age groups and all walks of life revealed to us their objects of desire. The data revealed some very interesting facts and trends.



Watch this space

Those of you who responded to our wishlist survey: we didn't pull a faux-Nigerian scam on you. We will indeed be fulfilling some of your wishes. Winners to be announced next month.

Now all you have to do is cleverly slip the magazine (strategically opened to this page) into your dad's briefcase or your elder brother's bag and they'll know exactly what to get you this Diwali. (You can thank us later.)

The Digit Diwali wishlist

We're not really data miners, but being geeks we came up with some interesting solutions. How do we recognise patterns in a file having a thousand plus lines? Eureka! Regular expressions! (read the *Regular Expressions* article in August issue for more)

Of course we had to keep track of the really absurd answers on paper. Many coffee cups and fits of laughter later, a picture began to emerge from the murky depths of reader's wishlists.

This Diwali I want a ...

We'll start with a bird's-eye view of our findings, segregating the products in the list into categories. Some of the wishes were quite vague: a good mobile phone, an excellent tablet, a nice set of speakers and so on. Until of course, we asked readers to be more specific. Then the requests for Intel Core i5 2500k 3.3 GHz and others started flowing in.

Everyone wants to be a mobile warrior !

It came as no surprise that smartphones, tablets and accessories together topped the list as the most desired category. Almost every respondent wanted a tablet or a smartphone, making up for 35 per cent of entries in the survey. There were literally hundreds of phones requested. Individually, mobile phones stole the show at 23 per cent followed by tablets and accessories. The front-runner among the mobile phones was the Samsung Galaxy S II, followed by the iPhone 4. Very surprising indeed. Good to know Android rules the roost with our readers. Then again, who wouldn't want the best phones in the market? Accessories also need a mention here. Readers asked for all sorts of accessories ranging from bluetooth headphones to chargers and micro SD cards. So say the person you are gifting already has a good phone, a gift which adds some extra functionality to the device is always welcome.

When considering tablets, the iPad 2 leads the pack followed by the Samsung Galaxy Tab 10.1. Bragging rights, you'd think, right? Not really. Some of the respondents wrote a few lines on why they needed and deserved to have their wishes fulfilled; and tablets were accompanied with a description on how they aim to use it for functional day-to-day usage. A few of the readers also asked for the Kindle too. So if you're looking to buy someone a fancy hard bound book-set, remember to consider the Kindle. You know, Confucius said, "Give a man a book, he'll read for a day, give him a kindle and he'll read for life."

Build me a killer rig !

You can rely on Digit readers to come up with a slew of entries wanting a precise component or peripheral, which will effectively help them build their dream rig. This category includes products such as processors, motherboards, RAM modules, graphic cards, power supplies, cabinets, speaker sets, mice, keyboards et al. twenty per cent of the respondents requested items from this categories. What surprised us was very that few readers asked for top of the line products. There was only one request for a GTX 590 and a Core i7 CPU. We had asked you guys to be reasonable; looks like you took our request quite seriously.